futureworks
consulting

ABOUT THE COMPANY

Established in 2009, FutureWorks is a trailblazer in admissions consulting, guiding over 10,000 students worldwide to secure spots in prestigious universities. Our unique approach focuses on holistic development, aiming to discover and nurture students' interests into meaningful academic and personal goals. With an exceptional success rate, we've facilitated 500+ Ivy League offers, 2500+ top 30 US University offers, 300+ top 5 UK University offers, and secured $15 million in scholarships.
We believe in a holistic process in which we first help students to discover and explore their interests, translate them into meaningful academic, career, and personal goals. Then, we develop a detailed plan to build a strong set of academic and extracurricular achievements, a unique positioning and narrative Focused on building students' skills – in reasoning and logical thinking, research, writing, speaking and networking – we help them in the application process, in college, and much beyond.
Passionate about building skills, we have been involved in developing and leading training programs since 2000, designing a 4 credit college course for IES Abroad that runs the programming for the top 200 US universities whose students study abroad in India and helping to design and pilot a high school program on Entrepreneurship with Columbia Business School which is now offered globally. Currently, we run the Emerging India Research Program and the Research Scholars Fellowship. In 2023, our Founder, Kavita Singh was honored for her work in education with St. Hugh's College, University of Oxford naming their flagship essay prize after her – the Kavita Singh Essay Prize in Politics, Philosophy and Economics.

Website: www.futureworks.co.in

JOB DESCRIPTION: WRITING SPECALISIT AND EDITOR

We are looking for full-time Writing Specialist & Editors & to join our team in New Delhi. This Writing and Editing Specialist position at FutureWorks Consulting will be a full-time, on-site role located in our office in Nizamuddin East. The ideal candidate will have strong writing and editing skills and a passion for working in the education industry.

We are looking for creative thinkers with outstanding communication and interpersonal skills who enjoy advising students on how to refine their written work, develop a unique voice and create a compelling narrative.

The Writing and Editing Specialist will be responsible for

1. Providing writing support to applicants, which includes

a. Brainstorming and guiding applicants to develop unique writing or application themes that effectively showcase their strengths and unique skills
b. Reviewing articles, essays, research proposals, resumes, recommendations and other documents to provide strategic feedback which may be provided in a written/oral format or in an in-person meeting.
c. Editing and proofreading materials such as articles, essays, research proposals, resumes, recommendations and other documents involved in building up a strong set of academic and extracurricular achievements and in putting together a strong application
d. Creating and delivering presentations to students on best practises when it comes to Essay Writing.

2. Editing and proofreading content for our admissions consulting services, workshops, and skill-building programs.

3. Writing articles, social media posts and creating presentations for the Company on the admissions process, on case studies, and on our current and new educational programs.

Qualifications

- Bachelor's degree in English, Journalism, Communications, or a related field preferred
- Proven ability to proofread and edit materials with a high level of accuracy and attention to detail
- Experience creating, writing, and editing materials such as essays, articles, and applications
- Strong writing skills and the ability to transform complex information into clear and concise language
- Familiarity with different writing styles, including AP and MLA, and the ability to apply them as needed
- Exceptional organizational skills and the ability to manage multiple projects with competing deadlines
- Excellent communication and interpersonal skills with a commitment to providing exceptional customer services

LOCATION

Location: Nizamuddin East

This is a full-time, in office position

CTC

The CTC range for this position is Rs. 6-9 Lakhs/p.a.

Location: Nizamuddin East, New Delhi

Working Hours: M-F – 9.30 am to 6.30 pm

HOW TO APPLY

Please email your CV and complete the assignment below. We will shortlist candidates for interview based on the CV and assignment

Assignment

Below is an old essay of a student

1. We would like you to edit it to word count – i.e. 650 words

   The essay question being answered was "Discuss an accomplishment or event, formal or informal, that marked your transition from childhood to adulthood within your culture, community, or family". This was a student applying to an undergraduate program in the US

2. Please feel free to make notes or comments that you would have wanted to share with the clients as well. We will be assessing both the quality of editing as well as the feedback you would have given to the clients.
   We know you don't have much background on the students (other than the essays) and will be taking that into account in our evaluation - so don't worry!

Essay:

I rested on my throne and sneered at the filthy woman who had dared to assist a traitor. "Wall her up in a cell for life, with enough food to acquit us of the taint of her blood!" Playing the role of King Creon, I gloated over Antigone crawling on the floor, as she justified the burial of her brother's corpse. As a king, I despised her. Yet, as a girl, I admired her for being a righteous protagonist and a symbol of feminism. I couldn't understand why she had failed.

In my childhood, I thought idealistic beliefs alone translate into victory. In Malala Yousafzai's case, she boldly fought for women's education rights. Although the Taliban shot her, she survived and went on to spread the value of education. But, over a cup of spiced tea, my aunt had once told me that in Vedanta, a Hindu philosophical guide to attaining enlightenment, it is said that you should never stand against something if you're mentally and physically weak. Malala's survival was miraculous luck and Antigone, though she fought for what was right, fought alone and unarmed. I realized that these were acts of imbecilic bravery, yet they inspired me. They made me realize that if the oppressed are naïve enough to fight without physical, mental or group strength they will lose.

So, this idea shaped my own little effort to empower girls by strengthening their confidence through communication and education. It all started with a workshop I conducted for, what I called, 'English Therapy' at Hamari Muskan: an organization that educates girls of trafficked women from the red-light district of Bowbazaar. In colonial British India, English, as the language of administration, became a tool of social advancement and the language of the elite. Post-independence, English was formerly withdrawn as the language of the government, yet

it remained a marker for an individual socio-economical status and the key to upward mobility. This was quite evident when I saw the milkman smile proudly when he was able to say ‘Good Morning!’ and I greeted him back, or even when I went to local shops, the shopkeeper was partial to me since I was able to speak English. Today, if the Hamari Muskan girls spoke English, not only would it improve employment chances, but, because of its social connotations, also ensure that their voices would be heard and grievances addressed.

Coming from strictly Bengali-speaking homes, none of the girls could mouth a sentence without a grammatical error or without a mix of their native dialect. On the first day, I remember when I asked them their favourite colours, all they did was stare at each other awkwardly without making a sound. Looking at their dull faces, it seemed like they had a mental block to never be able to speak English. The real task that impeded all my aims of teaching was the confidence to speak the language itself. I was clearly an outsider to them, so they feared wrong pronunciation and self-embarrassment. I needed to stir up the courage within them. To help them feel less inhibited, I completely descended from the autocratic teacher to the helpful playmate.

In a game of charades, tiny hands unfolded a paper to read ‘drinking’ and her sparkling eyes hinted that she knew what it meant. Holding a magical cup made of thin air she stood in front of rows of inquisitive eyes. “Kheichhe!” “Naa, naa, chaa!” They all spoke in impeccable Bengali. “Think again and speak English”, I asserted. It was utter chaos. I could see each one jumping on the floor to scream the right word and although half of them were wrong I felt secretly satisfied to see the enthusiastic effort.

I blindfolded her eyes as she squealed with thrill; we all encroached closer in a circle on the floor. Like a child, reliving the world through senses of sight, smell, touch and taste, her hands scrambled inside the bag of treasures. There was a moment of silence. ‘What is it?’ whispers were already going around. I was glad they whispered in English. She held out an orange. ‘What does it feel like?’ She rubbed her hand up and down and said ‘ru..ruu.. rough and smell is sour’. Smiles appeared on the uplifted cheeks.

Through these interactive games, I could see them cultivating the strength to overcome the mental block they had. Towards the end of the session, they would no longer look at me for reassurance before they uttered a word and would say what they had to without hesitating. The girls would proudly inform me about how Susmita went to the shop the other day and said ‘Can I have a bar of soap?’ or how Riya had been able to read the billboard sign that she had seen almost everyday for the past ten years of her life, or even how Rupa, the oldest, managed to read the name of ‘Premchand Boral Street’: where she has been living since she was born.

With English, I saw the girls developing mental strength- in that they were gaining the ability and the confidence to independently solve problems. Slowly I could see English becoming one more tool for the girls to better understand their surroundings. Even though they were using it in simple transactions, I could foresee that learning English was a building block in making them more equipped and less vulnerable to their environment. For suppose if they were lost, kidnapped or trafficked, they could be more aware of their location by reading billboards, street signs or road maps. By speaking a few English words, they could fight years of oppression by breaking the caste and socio-economic barrier. Although, they now had the power to reach out to others in English, I realized that they needed to be reassured that people would hear what they have to say.

So, on 22nd June 2014, I collaborated with fifty girls from underprivileged and affluent backgrounds to pull off a flash mob collaborated with 'One Billion Rising': a global campaign to end violence against women, rise for justice and promote gender equality. During practices, as I had anticipated, on one side, groups of high school girls chattered in English, whereas the Hamari Muskan children stood awkwardly and stared, the fear of speaking in English crept in. I had expected this to happen and now I wanted to break these barriers. The mission was to make them feel no different than the rest, show them that they weren't invisible and that their voices would be heard. This was as important as creating awareness of the issue.

The music echoed through the Kolkata New Market, drowning the horns of the yellow ambassador taxis, and flabbergasted eyes abruptly turned in our direction. Feet moved together to the right one two three tap, twist of the body to the left and our hands lifted upwards, stretching out to the people surrounding us in a gesture, pleading for sympathy. As I looked around me, girls from diverse lives danced to one beat and crowds of watchful pedestrians gathered. I understood that strength in numbers also bolsters the network of support built on interconnected people. I was no longer the little girl who believed in the utopian notion of the unequipped lone soldier. In my transition from childhood to adulthood, I had understood that strength, in its various aspects, was essential to winning any fight. The Hamari Muskan girls did not stammer anymore when they spoke English, or feel any different from the rest. After the performance, one of them confidently walked up to an interested passerby and explained what human trafficking was about, in plain English, boosting her self-esteem further. Flashing cameras hovered about, capturing the headlights whizzing by, the focused eyes of spectators and faces of innocent girls with well-drawn out lips, twinkling eyes, smiling chests, standing tall and proud.